

Ἑρμόδωρος ὁ Ἐφέσιος

Heraclitus and Plato in the Fragments of Hermodorus of Ephesus

eul_aid: eks

Period: [Κλασική Classical](#)
Dialect: [Ἰωνική Ionic](#)
Domain: [Φιλοσοφία Philosophy](#)
Format: [Συναγωγή Collection](#)
Affiliation: [Presocratic](#)

Hermodorus of Ephesus was a philosopher active in the 5th century BCE. He is known primarily as a disciple and close associate of the earlier thinker Heraclitus. Ancient sources report that Hermodorus was exiled from his home city of Ephesus and subsequently traveled to Italy.

According to a later tradition recorded by the Roman writer Cicero, Hermodorus was in Rome and assisted officials drafting the city's earliest law code, the Twelve Tables, by providing examples of Greek laws. This story places his activity in the mid-5th century BCE. Hermodorus did not leave behind any surviving writings of his own. Instead, his significance lies in his role as a transmitter of Heraclitus's ideas. Later sources, including a Byzantine encyclopedia, state that Hermodorus wrote a book about Heraclitus or was involved in publishing his master's work. His primary contribution was therefore preserving and explaining the complex philosophy of Heraclitus for later generations.

Modern scholars view Hermodorus as an important bridge between different cultures and eras. As a direct disciple, he was a key link in passing on Presocratic thought. The story of his involvement with early Roman law, while its historical accuracy is debated, reflects an ancient belief in the influence of Greek philosophy on the development of Roman institutions. Through these traditions, Hermodorus represents a connection between the philosophical circles of Ionia and the early Roman Republic.

Works (2)

- [Περὶ Πλάτωνος · On Plato](#) · 8 passages
- [Μαρτυρίαι καὶ Ἀποσπάσματα · Testimonies and Fragments](#) · 9 passages

Other Presocratic Authors

- [Ἀλκμαίων ὁ Κροτωνιάτης · Alcmaeon of Croton](#) · 2 works
- [Ἀναξαγόρας ὁ Κλαζομένιος · Anaxagoras of Clazomenae](#) · 2 works
- [Ἀναξίμανδρος ὁ Μιλήσιος · Anaximander of Miletus](#) · 2 works
- [Ἀναξίμενης ὁ Μιλήσιος · Anaximenes of Miletus](#) · 2 works
- [Ἀναξιμένους τοῦ Μιλησίου Ἐπιστολαί \(Ψευδο-Ἀναξίμενης\) · Anaximenes-pseudo Miletus Letters](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀρχέλαος ὁ Μιλήσιος ὁ Ἀθηναῖος · Archelaus of Miletus](#) · 2 works

- Κλεόβουλος ὁ Λίνδιος · Cleobulus of Lindos I · 1 work
- Δημόκριτος ὁ Ἀβδηρίτης · Democritus of Abdera · 2 works
- Διογένης ὁ Ἀπολλωνιάτης · Diogenes of Apollonia · 2 works
- Ἐμπεδοκλῆς ὁ Ἀκραγαντίνος · Empedocles of Acragas · 3 works
- Ἡράκλειτος ὁ Ἐφέσιος · Heraclitus of Ephesus · 2 works
- Ἡράκλειτος ὁ Ἐφέσιος · Heraclitus of Ephesus II · 1 work